



Honda's P2 would go on to be further refined



ASIMO

So far, robots were being used in space exploration, but the direction of design was to build one big multipurpose robot. In 1989, a research paper changed the direction of rover research. Instead of one big robot, the paper advocated the use of multiple small ones. This would change the way we designed rovers, especially for the Mars mission in the '90s.

The '90s were full of robotic advancements, as if decades of research and study were finally culminating into results. For example, Robots were already invading areas typically reserved for human skill. Cyberknife, a stereotactic radiosurgery robot released in 1994, could treat tumors by using a minimally invasive method, with an accuracy that was comparable to human doctors. The eight-legged walking robot Dante explored Mt. Erebus in Antarctica. Dante II, a more robust successor, subsequently explored Mt. Spurr in Alaska in 2004.

After almost a decade of research, Honda's P2, the first self regulating bipedal robot, and then P3, Honda's first completely autonomous robot, were ready to be publicly demonstrated.

The millennial robots

The dawn of the new millennium saw robotics reach everyday life and people like never before. ASIMO, the result of Honda's decade and a half worth of robotics research, was introduced to the world and it was the most advanced robot of its kind at that time.